Big Itoshima Route

Itoshima Peninsula · Fukuoka, Japan · Coastal loop from Chikuzen-Maebaru

ORIENT WHAT THE RIDE IS LIKE

A gentle **80.0 km loop** around the Itoshima Peninsula, ridden clockwise from Chikuzen-Maebaru Station. Sea on your right for most of the outbound leg — across Funakoshi Bay, past the white torii at Futamigaura, around the pine-clad headland at Keya. The return cuts inland through rice paddies and quiet farm roads. Traffic is **light on the coastal strip**, moderate through Maebaru town at start and finish. The route is Strava-popular but rarely crowded; cafés open late morning and close by early evening.

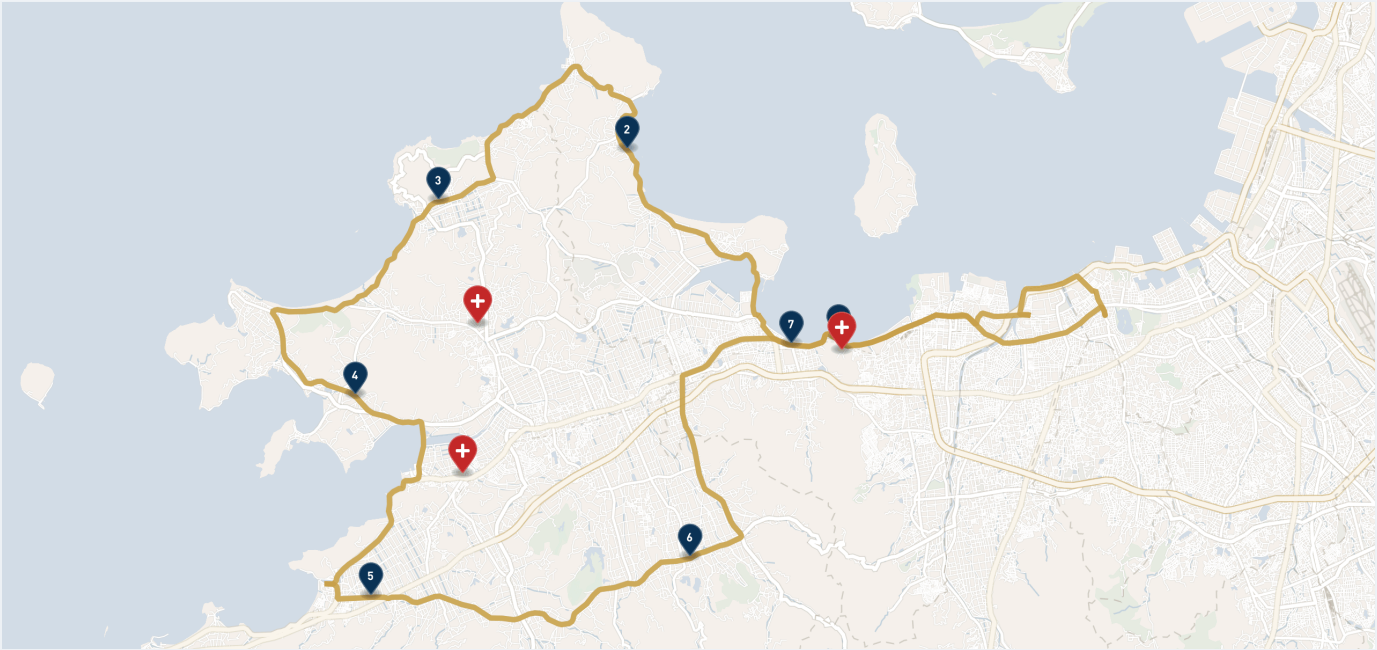
80.0	361	5.9%	5h 03
DISTANCE	CLIMB	STEEPEST	MOVING TIME
km · one loop	m total elevation gain	short coastal pinch	@ 18 km/h cruise

FRAME WHY THE DETAILS MATTER ON THIS RIDE

Itoshima rides are often treated as casual, but the loop is long enough that a mechanical or heat-exhaustion problem past the halfway point is a real logistics challenge. The three hospitals below are the **nearest emergency facilities** to the 10, 30, and 50 km waypoints — print this page or save it to your phone so a guide on the ground can call the correct one without guessing. Everything else — pacing, lunch, headwinds — is on page 2.

PRESENT ROUTE · WAYPOINTS EVERY 10 KM · NEAREST HOSPITALS

Waypoint (every 10 km) · Emergency hospital · Route



PRESENT NEAREST HOSPITALS

NEAREST TO WAYPOINT 1 · KM 10

春日病院

Japan, 〒819-0162 Fukuoka, Nishi Ward, Imajukuaoki, １１０５ 白翠園春日病院

092-891-3535

Rating: 2★ (3 reviews)

0.37 km from waypoint

NEAREST TO WAYPOINT 3 · KM 30

Oku Home Clinics

1-5 Shimainadomehigashi, Itoshima, Fukuoka 819-1317, Japan

092-327-3612

3.62 km from waypoint

NEAREST TO WAYPOINT 5 · KM 50

介護医療院すみれ

1-chōme-1-15 Kamiarinishi, Itoshima, Fukuoka 819-1148, Japan

092-331-1165

4.25 km from waypoint

BRIDGE · BEFORE YOU ROLL OUT

→ **Save the three hospital phone numbers** to your phone — you won't have time to look them up if things go wrong.

→ **See page 2** for the elevation profile, where the heat and wind actually bite, and the pacing plan.

→ **Download the GPX offline** — signage is almost entirely in Japanese, and phone coverage thins on the western headland.

GPX source: https://www.strava.com/routes/3418358467280238128 · Hospitals via Google Places

How the ride actually feels

Elevation, pacing, wind, seasonality — what the numbers on page 1 mean for the rider

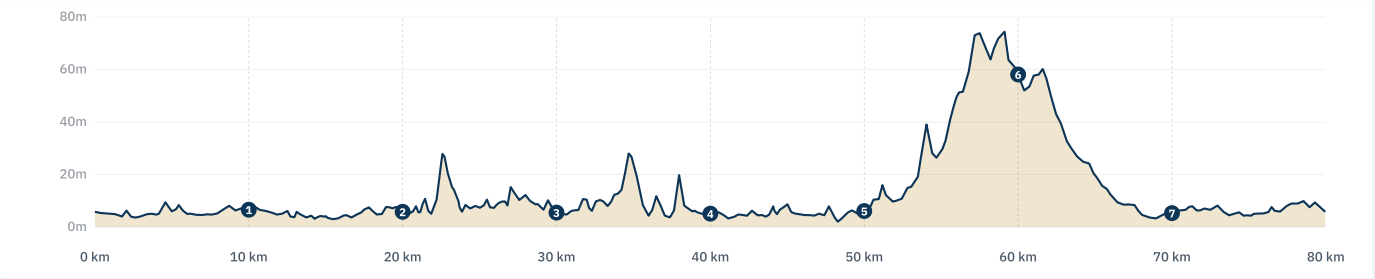
ORIENT WHAT THE TERRAIN FEELS LIKE

The profile is **flat-to-rolling** — there's no sustained climb anywhere on the loop. Total elevation of 361 m is misleading for a ride this length: the climb is scattered in short rises rather than one big ascent, so pacing is about **rhythm**, not reserve. The only real terrain event is a 5.9% pinch on the coastal approach around km 20, visible as the bump below. The high point of the loop is only 77 m above sea level.

FRAME WHERE THE REAL DIFFICULTY LIVES

> Riders misjudge this loop because the numbers look easy, but the **wind and heat on the inland return** drive the actual difficulty. Westerlies strengthen through mid-afternoon — schedule lunch at the westernmost point (Keya / Nogita, ~km 38) so the tailwind is with you on the long eastbound leg home. In summer, add hydration stops at each 10 km waypoint; the inland return has less shade than the coast.

PRESENT ELEVATION PROFILE



PRESENT WAYPOINT REGISTER

#	DISTANCE	ELEVATION	COORDINATES (LAT, LNG)
1	**10 km**	7 m	33.58173, 130.29023
2	**20 km**	6 m	33.62891, 130.22672
3	**30 km**	6 m	33.61615, 130.16982
4	**40 km**	5 m	33.56744, 130.14477
5	**50 km**	6 m	33.51709, 130.14955
6	**60 km**	58 m	33.52679, 130.24556
7	**70 km**	5 m	33.58021, 130.27596

PRESENT PRACTICAL RIDE TIPS

Season
Spring (Apr–May) and autumn (Oct–Nov) are best. Summer is hot and humid; typhoons possible Jun–Oct.

Direction
Ride clockwise — outbound sea views are on the right, and you finish the flat inland return with a tailwind.

Hydration
Convenience stores at km 0, ~25, and ~55. Fill bottles at each; the inland return has almost none.

Lunch
Keya or Nogita Beach area (km 30–38) — cafés with bike parking, open 11:00–16:00.

Bike
Road bike or touring bike with 28–32mm tyres. No technical terrain, no off-road sections.

Navigation
Signage is Japanese-only. Load the GPX to your head unit or phone before starting.

PRESENT EMERGENCY CONTACTS

JAPAN EMERGENCY
119
Fire / ambulance · 24 h

POLICE
110
Incident reporting

ETI360 DUTY LINE
+81 92 XXX XXXX
On-trip support

BRIDGE · RIDE-DAY CHECKLIST

- → **Weather** — check wind forecast before rolling out; westerly > 20 km/h makes the return hard.
- → **Pacing** — hold back on the outbound coast; the inland return always takes longer than you expect.
- → **Water** — two bottles minimum from the start, top up at km 25 and km 55.
- → **Incident** — note your waypoint number before calling; it maps directly to the hospital on page 1.

Elevation min/max: 1–77 m · descent: 361 m total